

C&S Wholesale Grocers, Inc. and Subsidiaries

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1. Purpose

This document establishes the requirement to provide a help desk operations infrastructure and support system to ensure that information services are readily available to internal and external users as needed. It further establishes processing steps, responsibilities, and acceptable levels of service when responding to customer requests.

2. Management Responsibilities

It is the manager's responsibility to ensure that his/her direct-report employees, interns, contractors, and/or third-party workers are aware of, and agree to abide by, the Company's requirements for Incident Management and that incidents are handled in accordance with the requirements of this policy.

3. Help Desk Operations Policy

3.1. Staffing

Help Desk Operations staffing will be maintained at a level that conveys to customers their requests are being addressed promptly and with a degree of urgency commensurate to the severity of the issues.

3.2. Training

Help Desk Operations analysts shall be trained to address routine customer inquiries without the need for referral or escalation. Help Desk Operations analysts shall be trained to recognize appropriate routing to the applicable solver group or staff agency for inquiries and problems beyond their expertise.

3.3. Operational Tasks

Help desk operations analysts will perform operational duties including; Monitoring, Scheduling and performing routine tasks.

3.4. Hours of Operation

Help Desk Operations will be staffed 24 hours a day, 7 days a week, 365 days a year.

3.5. Incident or Service Request Reporting

Internal and external customers requiring assistance on Information Services systems or services will contact the Help Desk Operations at (603) 354-7500 or (866) HELP883 or at helpdesk@cswg.com. Help Desk operations analyst shall log all incident or services requests as a ticket within the Information Services automated tracking system.

3.6. Incident or Service Request Classification

Incidents and Service requests shall be classified per CSISSD001 Incident Management Policy.

3.7. Incident Notification and Escalation

Incidents Notification and Escalation shall be performed in accordance with CSISSD001 Incident Management Policy. To expedite the process and minimize delays, an automated incident tracking system will be employed to the maximum extent practical in the issuance of notifications.

3.8. Trend Analysis

Statistics will be gathered on all incidents and service requests received by the Help Desk operations staff by request type for the purpose of analyzing trends within areas and solver groups. Information collected will be disseminated to individual solver groups so that they may take action to improve service levels and reduce backlogs. Adverse trends having broad impact throughout the Business will be brought to the attention of the VP, Information Services and the Senior Information Services Management Staff by the VP, IS Security and Service Delivery immediately upon identification.

3.9. Incident and Service Request Data Retention

Service request data retention will be sufficient to identify positive or negatives trends but shall not exceed Corporate or Departmental data retention limits.

4. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Help Desk Operation Manager	The Help Desk Operations Manager is responsible for ensuring that customer requests are processed or routed to the appropriate solver groups in a timely manner and that service provided is in accordance with established service level agreements and meets expectations.

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Role	Responsibility
Help Desk Operations Analyst	The individual responsible for interfacing with the customer to resolve or classify and route the customer's request.
Desktop / End-User Support	The End-User Support Team is the 2nd level of general Information Services support.
VP, IS Security and Service Delivery	The VP, IS Security and Service Delivery is the focal point for technology-based assets used by employees and contractors operating in an office environment, including desktop/laptop computers, printers, and telephony equipment. He or she is the owner of this policy and the principal architect of Help Desk Operations service level agreements between Information Services and the Business.
Solver Group Team (SGT)	The working level group of IS and Business personnel tasked to resolve a critical or high-level incident. Group composition can vary but will always include the principal ticket assignee and a team lead.

5. Definitions

Term	Definition
Automated Incident Tracking Application	A third party or internally developed, computer-based system for initiating, communicating, and monitoring disposition of incidents impacting the Information Services Production Environment.
Business	A generic organizational term defining company departments, areas, and agencies outside of Information Services. This would include, but is not limited to: Merchandising, Procurement, Warehousing, Finance, Human Resources, and Legal.
Business Interruption	An event or series of events that impacts one or more Information Services systems, precipitating a delay in the conduct of normal business operations for one or more areas of the Business.
Escalation	A systematic, time-driven process for ensuring that significant IS incidents are addressed promptly and that key decision makers are included in the process.
First Level Help Desk Operations Support	The initial point of contact within a help desk operations support hierarchy tasked with diagnosing the nature of incidents and requests. The first level responder assigns or validates incident priorities, and when the incident solution is within his or her expertise, assists the requestor in implementing the appropriate solution.
Incident	An event or correlated series of events which disrupt the normal functioning of the Information Services Production Environment.
Incident Severity Classification	A set of evaluation criteria employed to categorize the relative degree of impact a particular event has upon the IS Production Environment. The degree of severity can range from low to critical.
Incident Ticket	The initial form opened in the Help Desk Operations workflow automated incident tracking application to address an immediate situation. It serves as the vehicle for tracking a speedy resolution to this situation.
Automated Service Desk Application	A computer-based program designed to facilitate the recording, monitoring, routing, and resolution of service requests, incidents, and change orders pertaining to Information Services systems and equipment.
Change Order	A documented requirement for modification to services, systems, applications, software, or equipment within the Information Services Production Environment.
Customer	Within the context of this document, a customer is any internal or external user of systems and services provided by the Information Services Department.
First Level Support	First level support constitutes that initial contact made between a customer and a help desk operations analyst. Routine tickets within the expertise of the analyst taking the call are processed and resolved at this level.

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Term	Definition
Need By Date	The Need By Date is the anticipated completion date originally set by the user. If a change is needed, it can be modified as agreed by the requestor, any member of the primary Solver Group, and his or her respective manager.
Security Access Request (SAR)	A SAR is a specific form of Change Order involving the granting of access rights to one or more services in the Production Environment. A SAR is also the mechanism used by a customer to obtain new software or equipment required to effectively conduct his or her daily activities supporting business operations.
Service Level Agreement (SLA)	A documented metric or set of metrics mutually agreed upon by the customer and IS that defines the targeted level for acceptable performance. SLA's, while primarily based on ticket priority, should also consider the Need By Date as part of the overall determination for success. Further, while Priority is a success determinant, it is important to note that as part of the process, it can be modified with requestor concurrence.
Service Request	A request from a customer for information, advice, or access to services, systems, applications, software, or equipment provided, maintained, and/or supported by the company's Information Services Department.
Solver Group	An Information Services entity comprised of individuals dedicated to supporting one or more systems or functions essential to the collection, processing, and distribution of information necessary to the successful conduct of business activities.
Ticket	Within the context of this document, a ticket is a generic term referring to a physical or electronic form used to record and monitor activity pertaining to a service request, an incident, or a change order.

6. Related Documents

- CSISSD001 - Incident Management Policy